CALVARY EXOTICS

CARE SHEET · HUSBANDRY GUIDE

Viper Gecko



Hemidactylus imbricatus. A compact, strikingly patterned, communal gecko from the arid scrublands of Pakistan and northwestern India. Dry tank, wet micro-zones, and tight crevice hides.

ORIGIN	ACTIVITY	SOCIAL	DIET
Pakistan / India	**Nocturnal**	**Communal; thrives in groups**	**Insectivore**

TANK

- **Juvenile group (2–3):** 20 × 10 × 12 in.
- **Adult group (2–4):** 30 × 12 × 12 in.
- **Vertical background:** full-height cork bark wall packed with cavities and nooks, with moss in the nooks. Open space makes them feel exposed.
- **Substrate:** bioactive mix with a drainage layer, topped with sand. Keep the area along the back wall exposed for local humidity.
- **Avoid:** coconut hides, coconut fiber substrate, enclosed plastic hides.
- Groups: one male with several females, or all females. Males can fight.

LIGHTING

- **UVB:** low output, Arcadia Shade Dweller or Jungle Dawn (about 5–7%). Helps prevent metabolic bone disease. Replace bulbs every 6–12 months.
- **Heat:** Zoo Med 35W Nano Halogen on a thermostat with probe.
- Mount lights along the top of the back panel with a wide gradient.
- Give a complete lights-out night cycle.

TEMPERATURE

ZONE	TARGET
Hot spot (top of cork)	90–95°F
Mid background	80°F
Cool side	75°F max
Night	68–72°F; never heat overnight

HUMIDITY

AREA	TARGET
Tank ambient	30–40%
Cork background	40–65%
Nook interiors	75–90%
Nighttime spike	60–80%

Lightly mist the back wall and hide entrances each evening or morning so water wicks into the moss. Sustained high ambient humidity leads to respiratory infection.

FEEDERS & DIET

- **Preferred:** dubia and discoid nymphs, crickets (gut-loaded, not the main staple), isopods, silkworms, hornworms, buffalo beetles and larvae.
- **Occasional only:** small mealworms and small superworms. High fat; can cause impaction if overfed.
- **Schedule:** 3–4 appropriately sized prey items per gecko every 2–3 days, in the evening after lights out.
- **Supplements:** calcium (with D3) twice a week and a multivitamin once a week. Rotate calcium with and without D3 if using proper UVB.

COMMON ISSUES

ISSUE	WHAT TO DO
Retained shed	Mist the background more; add a humid moss hide. Stuck toe shed can cut off circulation.
Not eating	New geckos may skip 1–2 weeks. Reduce disturbance, check hot spot, vary feeders.
Dropped tail	Regrows with a different look. Keep substrate clean and dry.
Group fighting	Add nooks, space, basking areas, and food.
MBD	Soft or bowed limbs, tremors. Check UVB, dust feeders.
Respiratory	Wheezing, mucus. See a vet; improve ventilation, lower humidity.
Egg binding	Bloated or straining female. Emergency: provide deep moist lay site, call a reptile vet.

NEEDED ITEMS CHECKLIST

- ☐ Tank, 20×10 or 30×12 in; cork bark panel or DIY background
- ☐ Substrate: sand, soil, moss & leaf litter
- ☐ Escape-proof feeder dish; shallow water dish; feeder tongs
- ☐ Cork bark hides, pieces and slabs
- ☐ UVB lamp; Zoo Med 35W Nano Halogen; thermostat
- ☐ Fine-mist spray bottle; calcium supplement

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